WAVERLEY GATEWAY GUIDE

Connecting International Capital with Emerging & Frontier Markets

COMOROS

Africa

Information current as of October 2026

Dialogue | Trust | Partnership

office@lordwaverley.com
www.lordwaverley.com

WHERE AND HOW TO ENTER

KEY INVESTMENT LOCATIONS

Location / Region	Strategic Importance	Priority Sectors
Moroni (Ngazidja / Grande Comore)	Capital and commercial centre; seat of the Union government, the central bank and the concessioned Moroni container terminal	Trade, financial services, construction, retail
Moroni port and the Maritime Corridor programme	Launch point (October 2025) of a $137 million AfDB-backed port and trade-facilitation programme, with more than $110 million of co-financing from partners	Port logistics, construction, trade services
Mutsamudu (Ndzuani / Anjouan)	Main town of Anjouan and a key port for inter-island and regional shipping	Port services, agro-processing, essential oils
Mwali (Mohéli)	Smallest and least developed island, with a largely natural coastline suited to nature-based tourism	Eco-tourism, fisheries, agriculture
Spice and essential-oil growing areas (all three islands)	Comoros supplies around 80% of the world's ylang-ylang and is a recognised exporter of cloves and vanilla	Agro-industry, fragrance supply chains, certification and export
International airport (Moroni)	Main air gateway, now concessioned to an Emirati operator under a modernisation public-private partnership	Aviation services, tourism, logistics
Venues for the 2027 Indian Ocean Island Games	Comoros hosts the regional games in 2027, driving investment in ports, roads and hotels	Hospitality, construction, tourism

INVESTOR ENTRY ROUTES

- Agence Nationale pour la Promotion des Investissements (ANPI), the national investment promotion agency, receives approval applications under the Investment Code and organises the "Business in Komor" investor fair
- Investment Code adopted by Law No. 20-035/AU of 28 December 2020, which the authorities present as among the most attractive in the region, with an approval regime for incentives
- Euro-pegged Comorian franc (1 euro = 491.968 KMF) backed by an unlimited French convertibility guarantee, with transfers in principle free within the franc zone
- Banque Centrale des Comores oversight of banking and foreign-exchange matters; policy rate cut to 2.5% in January 2026
- Public-private partnerships and concessions in ports and aviation, as shown by the Moroni container terminal and the international airport concession

- Procurement under donor-financed programmes, including the Maritime Corridor and Regional Trade Facilitation Project, whose tenders were scheduled from February 2026
- OHADA business-law framework, giving investors a harmonised commercial and arbitration regime shared with other member states across Africa

MARKET-ENTRY OBSERVATION

Comoros in October 2026 is a small, stable and reforming island economy with a strong monetary anchor and growing international integration. Real GDP grew 3.8% in 2025, the strongest outturn in recent years, after 3.3% in 2024; the World Bank expects 3.2% in 2026 and 4.0% in 2027, while the IMF projected 4.1% for 2026. The euro peg, backed by France's convertibility guarantee, underpins price stability: inflation fell from a peak of 7.3% in March 2025 to 1.9% in October 2025, although higher energy and food prices are lifting it in 2026. Reserves stand at about $395 million, or 9.4 months of imports. Comoros became the WTO's 165th member in August 2024, applies the EU interim Economic Partnership Agreement and is on track under a $43 million IMF Extended Credit Facility running to 2027, with 13 of 15 structural benchmarks met in the latest review. FDI is modest, at a stock of $158 million in 2024, leaving significant room for first movers.

The main structural challenge is infrastructure, above all reliable electricity, water and port capacity, which the IMF identifies as a constraint on investment; fuel supply pressures in 2026 linked to Middle East disruption added to this. Comoros has shown resilience: diaspora remittances, worth around 18% of GDP in 2025, rose 13.5% in the first four months of 2026, and reserves remain well above the benchmark for small states. Mitigation is under way through the $137 million AfDB-led port programme, co-financed by the World Bank, Islamic Development Bank, AFD, EU and EIB, and through a World Bank portfolio of $454 million across energy, transport and water. For investors, the same gaps are the opportunity: renewable power, port and logistics services, hospitality ahead of the 2027 games, and higher-value processing of the islands' spices and essential oils.

INVESTOR RISK & MARKET ACCESS

KEY ENTRY BARRIERS

Issue	Potential Impact	Possible Mitigation
Electricity and fuel supply	Power and water supply gaps raise operating costs, and fuel supply was rationed in 2026 amid Middle East disruption	Build in on-site generation or solar-plus-storage; energy is a donor priority and a clear opening for renewable-power investors
Port and transport infrastructure	Port capacity and inter-island links add to trade costs for an archipelago economy	The $137 million Maritime Corridor programme and its co-financing are upgrading ports; investors can position for related works and services
Small, dispersed domestic market	A population of about 910,000 across three islands limits scale for purely domestic businesses	Target export, tourism and regional-trade models using COMESA, SADC, WTO and EU market access
Banking sector depth	Financial assets are about 38% of GDP and non-performing loans were 13.8% in October 2025, which limits local credit	Use DFI and trade finance; IMF-supported bank recapitalisation and supervision reforms are strengthening the sector
Governance and business environment	Institutional capacity is still developing, and reforms on procurement transparency, asset declarations and AML/CFT are in progress	Engage through ANPI, use OHADA arbitration and donor-financed procurement, and apply standard due diligence
Public debt and fiscal space	Public debt is moderate at about 33% of GDP, but the IMF rates the risk of debt distress as high and the tax take is low	Revenue reforms under the IMF programme are continuing; favour projects with DFI, grant or PPP backing rather than reliance on state payments
Climate and commodity exposure	The islands are exposed to cyclones, and export earnings depend on vanilla, cloves and ylang-ylang prices	Insure assets and build climate-resilient designs; diversification into processing and tourism reduces concentration

INVESTOR RISK NOTE

Comoros's risk profile is that of a small island state with a strong monetary anchor and an active reform programme. The euro peg and France's convertibility guarantee give investors currency predictability rare among peer economies, inflation has eased from its 2025 peak, and reserves cover more than nine months of imports. The IMF Extended Credit Facility, WTO membership since 2024 and a substantial pipeline of multilateral finance are steadily improving the policy and infrastructure base. Politically, President Azali Assoumani has provided continuity since his re-election in January 2024, a result the opposition disputed. The main practical considerations are energy supply, infrastructure, the depth of local banking and the IMF's high debt-distress rating, which make DFI partnership and careful counterparty selection advisable. Investors who plan for self-supplied power and structure projects with multilateral backing can take advantage of an early-stage market with limited competition.

MARKET ACCESS

Comoros is a member of both the Common Market for Eastern and Southern Africa (COMESA) and the Southern African Development Community (SADC), as well as the Indian Ocean Commission, the African Union and the Arab League, giving it a bridging position between eastern and southern Africa, the Indian Ocean islands and the Gulf. It became the WTO's 165th member on 21 August 2024 after 17 years of negotiations, and it has applied the EU interim Economic Partnership Agreement with Eastern and Southern African states since February 2019, providing duty-free, quota-free access to the EU market. Its main export markets are in Asia and the European Union, with cloves, vanilla and ylang-ylang the leading exports. Its location in the Mozambique Channel underpins the government's plan, backed by the AfDB-led port programme, to position the islands as a logistics link between Africa and Asia.

WHO SHOULD THE INVESTOR MEET?

INSTITUTIONAL LANDSCAPE

Actor	Why It Matters	Waverley Engagement Angle
Office of the President (Azali Assoumani)	Sets national economic priorities, including the Plan Comores Émergent development strategy launched in 2019	Primary reference point for strategic direction and major projects
Agence Nationale pour la Promotion des Investissements (ANPI)	National investment promotion agency; processes Investment Code approval applications and promotes the country to investors	Standard first point of contact for market entry and incentives
Banque Centrale des Comores	Manages the euro-pegged Comorian franc, monetary policy and banking supervision	Relevant for currency, transfers and banking-sector matters
Ministry of Finance	Leads budget, tax and customs reforms and the IMF programme	Key counterpart for fiscal incentives, PPPs and tax matters
Ministry of Maritime and Aviation Transport	Implementing ministry for the Maritime Corridor programme and responsible for port and aviation policy	Essential partner for port, logistics and aviation opportunities
Moroni Terminal (port concession)	Private concessionaire operating the Moroni container terminal under a concession with the state	Practical counterpart for shipping, logistics and import planning
African Development Bank and World Bank	Lead financiers of ports, energy, transport and water programmes	Sources of co-financing, procurement opportunities and risk mitigation

CURRENT INTERNATIONAL BUSINESS CHANNELS

ANPI is the main channel for investor contact and runs the "Business in Komor" investor fair, whose 2023 edition coincided with the annual conference of the francophone network of investment promotion agencies. France maintains business support in Moroni through its embassy's economic department, Business France and a bilateral chamber of commerce, and AFD is an active development partner. The African Development Bank, World Bank, Islamic Development Bank, European Union and European Investment Bank all finance current programmes, and their procurement notices are a practical route to early contracts. Gulf partners are present, notably through the airport concession, and the large Comorian diaspora in France is an important source of capital, market knowledge and local contacts.

INVESTOR PROFILE BEST SUITED

Comoros suits investors seeking an early-stage, euro-anchored market with limited competition: renewable-energy and utility investors addressing the clear power gap; port, logistics and construction firms positioned for the donor-financed corridor programme and the 2027 games; hospitality and eco-tourism investors attracted by the islands' unspoilt coastline; and agro-industry and fragrance-sector investors seeking secure supplies of ylang-ylang, cloves and vanilla and higher-value local processing. Smaller, patient investors working alongside development finance institutions, and diaspora-linked enterprises, are especially well placed.

FROM INTELLIGENCE TO ENGAGEMENT

STEP 1: Engage ANPI and secure Investment Code approval
Open direct dialogue with the national investment promotion agency to confirm the approval process and the tax and customs benefits available for the project.

STEP 2: Track donor-financed procurement
Monitor tenders under the Maritime Corridor programme and World Bank and AfDB projects in energy, transport and water, which offer early, well-financed entry points.

STEP 3: Plan energy self-sufficiency from the outset
Budget for on-site generation or solar-plus-storage and explore utility-scale renewable opportunities with the authorities and development partners.

STEP 4: Structure with DFI partners and the euro peg in mind
Use multilateral co-financing, guarantees and trade finance to offset limited local credit, and take advantage of the euro-pegged currency for pricing and transfers.

STEP 5: Position for the 2027 Indian Ocean Island Games
Assess hospitality, construction and tourism-services opportunities linked to the games and to the wider tourism agenda.